Kasauli Rhythm and Blues Festival, Kasauli



The latest edition of the KRBF, Kasauli's beloved assemblage of lovers of music and the hills, featured the duo Hari & Sukhmani and the iconic Parikrama. Usually held over two days, the festival will turn a decade old this year, and has featured iconic artists such as Usha Uthup, Rabbi Shergill, and Kutle Khan, to name a few. One more reason to head to KRBF?



NH7 Weekender, Various cities

The NH7 Weekender is touted as one of South Asia's largest music festivals. Ever since debuting in 2010, the much-loved fest has been held across the country. The 13th edition of the festival had Shillong as the partner city, and featured a line-up boasting acts including The Lumineers, Mame Khan, Kr$na, HanuMankind, J.I.D, not to forget the Berklee Indian Ensemble.

Escape Festival of Arts & Music

When it started, Escape was known as the music festival with a venue to kill for. The lakeside environs of Naukuchiatal offered a superb setting to witness some stirring performances, with headliners including iconic rock acts like Delhi band Them Clones and Mumbai's ToT to Skinny Alley from Kolkata, a regular feature at the event, and the representatives of 'Bangalore rock', Thermal and a Quarter. In 2015, the festival moved to Ladakh.





Mahindra Blues, Mumbai

The 70-year-old Mehboob Studios in Bandra forms the backdrop for one of India's most popular blues festivals. Assembling iconic names in the genre from all over the world every year, Mahindra Blues has in the past featured the Tedeschi Trucks Band and Shillong's Soulmate. Buddy Guy himself headlined the 2020 edition. MBF 2023 is scheduled for February 11-12.

Hornbill Festival, Nagaland

Held in the heritage village of Kisama, Hornbill has seen appearances by both renowned and emerging indie bands and artists. In 2019, the Hornbill International Rock Contest–a popular competition–was discontinued. In its place, the Hornbill Music Festival, a separate experiential offering, has been launched, and is organised across Kohima and Dimapur.



SHUTTERSTOCK



SHUTTERSTOCK

Ziro Festival of Music, Arunachal Pradesh

Much before Arunachal Pradesh stamped its offbeat appeal on the tourist map, this outdoor music festival, created by Anup Kutty and Bobby Hano, had begun drawing indie music lovers to the Ziro Valley. For the past decade or so, ZFM has hosted an eclectic mix of musicians, including Divine, Indus Creed, Peter Cat Recording Co., Menwhopause, and Lou Majaw.

-with Prannay Pathak